Boss Tank

Intro

The boss tank is a simple boss battle that introduces the player to the boss mechanics.
The player should learn how to deal with shielded enemies in this fight.
The fight requires the player to time throws in order to knock out the boss.
The Boss Tank is supported by several BuddyTanks that remain in formation.

Type

Ground, Big Tank, Squad.

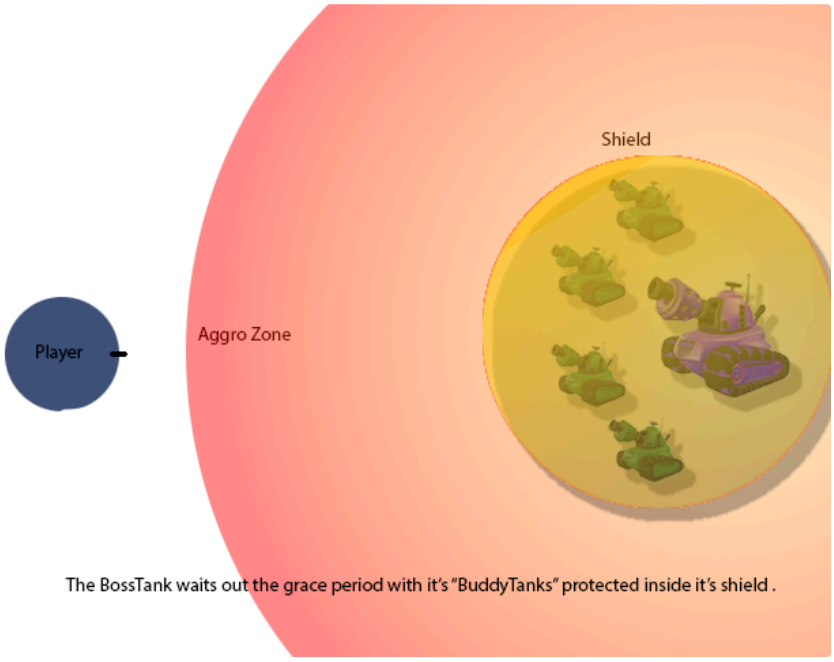
Spawn

The Boss Tank spawns when the player completes the level's 🏆Win Conditions, Goals & Modes (Single- & Multiplayer).

When the Boss Tank & BuddyTanks spawn the other city defenders will retreat and disappear.

The boss will spawn (teleport) into the level near a landmark where there is open ground, likely a park, roundabout or major intersection.

When the player is within range or if the grace period expires, the boss goes from idle to engaging the player.



Grace period posture

Movement

The Boss Tank is an enlarged tank with a small squad of Buddy Tanks. The Boss will attempt to cover the Buddy Tanks with it's shield when slow or idle.

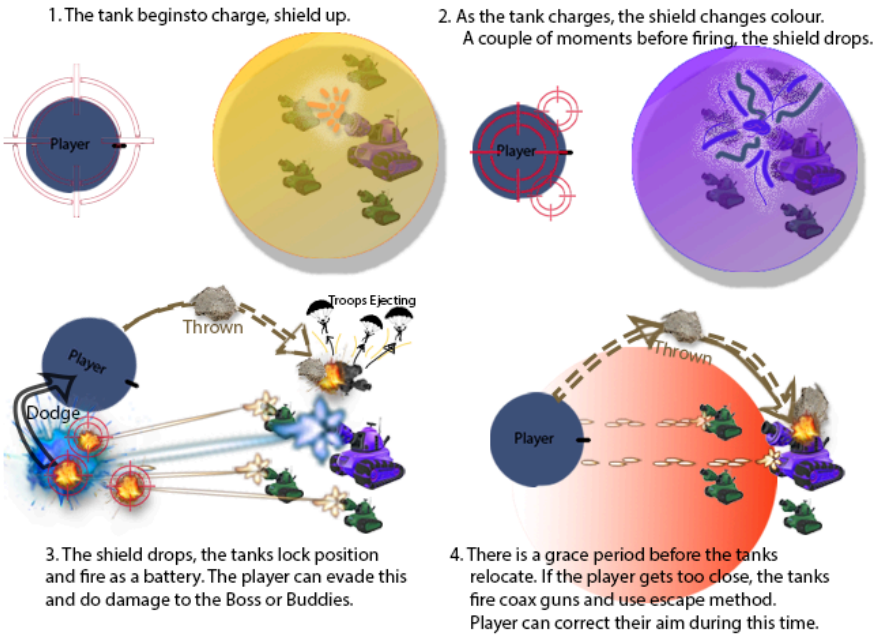
The shield cannot be maintained during quick movements.

The boss will attempt to maintain distance from the player and prefers to come to a stop near an intersection. The intersection allows quick egress and cover if damaged by the player.

Rotation

Unless doing an attack sequence, the Boss Tank and Buddy Tanks will always rotate to face the player.
The Buddy Tanks will reposition themselves to the flanks of the Boss Tank to give it clear line of sight to the player.

Attack



Attack pattern and player strategy

When at ideal distance from player, the Boss Tank will initiate it's attack phase.
The Boss Tank will begin charging it's main weapon while the shield remains in place.
A "Wind-Up" sound and glow telegraphs the attack to the player.
As the power of the attack builds, the level of sound and size of the particle effect increases, the shield changes colour and darkens. Reticles from the tanks are projected on the ground beneath

the player.

Before the beam is unleashed the shield drops - this telegraphs to the player that the attack is about to happen. There is a moment to spare before it is unleashed.

The Tanks lock in on the players position, an audible mechanical beep is heard as the targets lock.
The Tanks fire as a battery, their shots landing close to the position the player occupied at lock.

If the boss hits the player, they stay in place and prepare a second attack.
If the boss misses the player, the squadron rolls out and attempts to attack the player from a new intersection.

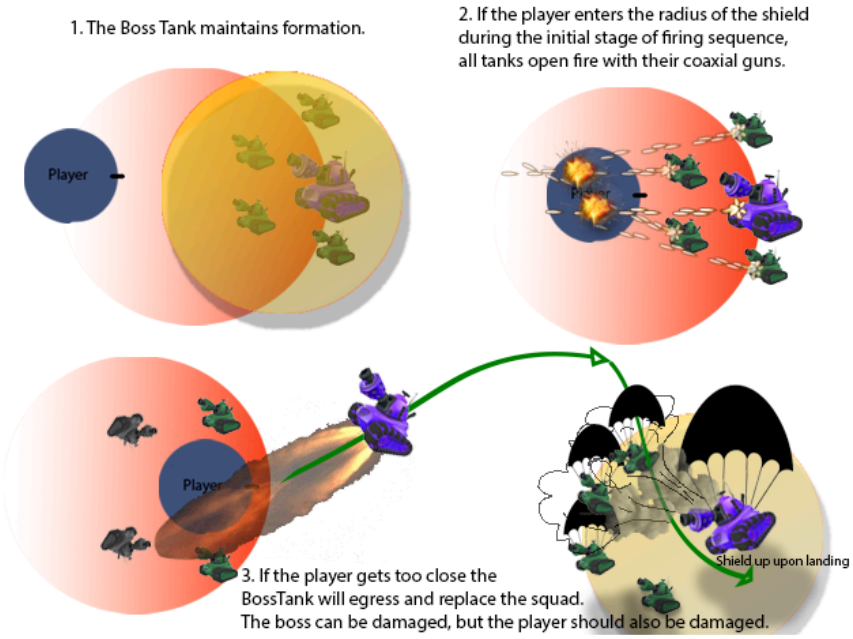
The beam goes through (destroys) enemies, obstacles and buildings if it misses the player.
The explosions cause damage to city infrastructure inside of a radius and kick up some debris.

Defence

The unit is surrounded by an energy shield.

If the player touches the energy shield, the player loses 10 HP and will be electrocuted (😖 Status Effects) making the hand numb and useless so the player has to shake it to recover control of that hand quickly (else the effects goes away after 8 seconds on its own, shaking it reduces the time to just 2 seconds). Upon touch the boss will act according to it's retreat sequence.

The shield is invulnerable against direct Special Power Damage.



Defense and Egression

If the player approaches the TankBoss during the firing sequence, the squad will rake the player with fire from the coaxial turrets.

If the boss takes damage from thrown objects, or if the player is in close proximity, the boss will launch itself upwards and backwards before deploying a parachute for a soft landing. The player is burned by the backblast from the rocket if they are too close.

On descent, the Boss Tank will re-deploy any BuddyTanks that have been killed.
The Boss Tank's shield will redeploy on landing.

The player can short out the shield by throwing objects at it.
As the shield takes damage, it becomes more opaque and emits electrical particles.
Before breaking it is about 70% opaque and very covered in static (see Smash-Bros for reference).
If shorted in the manner, the shield remains off until the completion of the next firing sequence or until the boss completes and egression.

If the BuddyTanks are all knocked out, the player is rewarded.
The shield remains down until the boss takes damage and deploys a new squad.

Destroyed BuddyTanks eject paratroopers which subsequently charge the player, providing a small rage boost and health feedback loop.

The boss cannot be grabbed and will simply launch away if the attempt is made, burning the player.

Player strategy

1. Watch for the tank to begin charging it's attack. Prepare objects to throw.
2. Move away quickly from the targeting reticle once it locks.
3. Lob objects into the formation before the shield is replaced in an attempt to hit the boss.
4. Pursue the boss to a new location and repeat.

And/Or

1. Knock out BuddyTanks one by one until the Boss Tanks shield remains down, leaving it open for an easy throw.

And/OR

1. Lob objects into the shield to overload it, giving extra time for either of the above strategies.

Staging

For each time the Boss Tank receives damage, the movement speed increases and the charge-up time decreases, and it deploys one extra BuddyTank upon egression.

Once the player has successfully damaged the Boss Tank 3 times, the tank explodes in dramatic fashion.

The Boss Tank damaged once emits steam particles and occasional electrical arcs.

A Boss Tank damaged twice emits steam, electric arcs and the engine is on fire.

Weapon configurations

Type	Ammo	Shots per burst	Pause between burst	Damage per shot
Coaxial Turret	Bullet	Rapid Fire	None	10
Big Gun	Rocket	One	TBD	TBD (but heavy)